

Sunartn

Developer Brief

A global marketplace for authentic Indian handcraft — from artisan to the world

Version 1.0

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Domain sunartn.com

Stage Pre-build prototype complete

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1. What *Sunartn* is

Sunartn is a two-sided international marketplace where **sellers are artisans based in India** and **buyers are anywhere in the world outside India**. Every product on the platform must be genuinely handmade. The platform is positioned as the

premium, story-first alternative to Etsy for Indian craft — closer in feel to a cultural institution than a generic marketplace.

The name combines Sunar (craftsperson, goldsmith in Hindi) with Art. The visual identity uses the S lettermark with sun rays, representing craft, energy, and the sun as a life-giving source.

Mission: Give India's artisans a direct channel to international buyers, eliminate middlemen, and take age-old Indian craft traditions to the world.

Domain registered: sunartn.com (GoDaddy)

2. What has already *been built*

Seven fully designed, interactive HTML prototype pages exist and must be used as the visual specification for development. Do not redesign. Build these exactly.

- 1 sunartn-homepage-v2.html**
Full buyer-facing landing page with hero, categories, featured products, artisan story section, seller CTA, and footer.
- 2 sunartn-product-detail.html**
Product page with image gallery, artisan card, pricing, options, trust row, tabs (details, craft, shipping, reviews), and artisan story section.
- 3 sunartn-cart-checkout.html**
Full 4-step checkout: cart with live quantity controls, delivery address with customs duty estimate, payment, and order confirmation.
- 4 sunartn-seller-onboarding.html**
Seller registration: 4-step form covering artisan profile, first product upload, pricing and payment details, and review with Rs 150 joining fee.
- 5 sunartn-seller-dashboard.html**
Seller backend: sidebar navigation, overview with alerts and charts, orders table with packing guide, listings grid, and earnings with payout history.
- 6 sunartn-artisan-profile.html**
Public artisan profile: story, timeline, craft process, quote, products, impact stats, reviews, and similar artisans.
- 7 sunartn-developer-brief.html**
This document.

3. Business logic *and rules*

Seller onboarding fee

Every new seller pays **Rs 150 one-time joining fee**. This is not a revenue stream — it is a commitment filter to ensure serious sellers only. The Rs 150 is **fully refunded after the seller's first completed sale**. This must be handled as a refundable deposit, not a charge.

Commission model

Sunartn charges **12% commission on every sale** (gross sale value). The remaining 88% is paid to the artisan. Commission is deducted before payout, not added to buyer price.

Escrow and payout model

- **New seller (Tier 1):** Payout held for 7 days after delivery confirmation.
- **Verified seller (Tier 2, Aadhaar verified):** Payout within 3 days of delivery.
- **Trusted seller (Tier 3, 10+ sales, 4.5+ rating):** Same-day payout.
- All payouts in INR via UPI or bank transfer. Currency conversion from buyer currency to INR handled at Stripe level.

Seller tier system

TIER	NAME	REQUIREMENTS	BENEFITS
1	New seller	Paid Rs 150 fee	Max 5 listings, 7-day payout hold
2	Verified artisan	Aadhaar OTP + live selfie match via DigiLocker	50 listings, 3-day payouts, Verified badge
3	Trusted seller	10+ completed sales, 4.5+ average rating	Unlimited listings, same-day payout, featured placement
4	Sunartn master artisan	Community nomination + team approval	Homepage feature, press opportunities, white-glove logistics

Authenticity rules

- Every product must be genuinely handmade. Machine-made goods are prohibited.
- Reverse image search on every product photo upload via Google Vision API to detect stock or stolen images.

- One seller account per Aadhaar ID. Device fingerprinting catches duplicate registrations.
- Random spot-check: Sunartn purchases 1 item per seller per quarter for physical inspection.
- Community flagging system: other artisans and buyers can flag suspected machine-made items.

Fraud prevention

- Buyer money held in escrow until shipment confirmed (tracking scan required within 72 hours of order).
- Auto-refund if no dispatch within 72 hours. 2 missed shipments = account suspension.
- Reviews only from verified buyers with completed orders.
- Stripe Radar for card fraud. 3D Secure mandatory for international orders above \$50.
- Photo-on-delivery required for orders above Rs 5,000.

Shipping and packaging

- Sunartn sends a pre-labelled packing kit to the artisan before or at time of pickup. Kit cost Rs 40 to 80, recovered via Rs 50 to 80 packaging fee shown at checkout.
- Shipping paid by buyer. Three options: Standard (India Post EMS, free), Express (DHL, \$12), Priority (DHL, \$24).
- Import duty shown as estimate at checkout based on destination country.
- Returns policy: donate-not-return for items under Rs 15,000. Buyer keeps or donates item, Sunartn refunds from insurance pool.
- Shipping insurance pool: 1.5 to 2% of every order value auto-allocated.

Government integrations (to be built over time)

- ODOP (One District One Product) scheme: tag listings with verified GI craft categories.
- Craftmark and Handloom Mark: show certification badge on eligible products.
- TRIFED: integrate tribal artisan network for TRIFED-registered sellers.
- Aadhaar DigiLocker API: for Tier 2 seller verification.
- MSME Udyam: help artisans register, link profile to Udyam number.

4. User types and *journeys*

Seller types

- **Independent artisan:** Solo maker in a village. Onboarded via WhatsApp. Needs zero tech skills. Hindi-first interface.
- **SHG or artisan collective:** Women's self-help group or cooperative. One account, multiple makers, shared revenue split.
- **Handicraft SME or export house:** Established business seeking global reach. Bulk catalog, business dashboard, B2B tools.

Buyer types

- **International conscious buyer:** UK, US, Australia, Europe. Values authenticity, story, sustainability.
- **NRI diaspora buyer:** Indians living abroad. High trust, nostalgic connection, repeat buyers.
- **Corporate gifting buyer:** Companies ordering bulk for Diwali, client gifts, ESG programs.

Critical seller journey

1. Artisan discovers Sunartn via WhatsApp, word of mouth, or field partner.
2. Sends 3 photos via WhatsApp. AI creates listing draft with translated description.
3. Artisan completes onboarding form (see prototype), pays Rs 150 joining fee.
4. Listing reviewed and approved within 24 hours.
5. Order received. WhatsApp alert sent. Packing kit delivered or already at hand.
6. Artisan packs, hands to courier or post office.
7. Buyer receives item. Artisan paid in INR via UPI within tier payout window.
8. Rs 150 refunded after first successful delivery.

5. Required *integrations*

INTEGRATION	PURPOSE	PRIORITY
Stripe Connect	International buyer payments, FX, commission splits, artisan payouts	Launch critical
Shiprocket API		Launch critical

	Logistics aggregator: auto-books DHL, India Post, FedEx. Tracking, customs docs, label generation	
WATI (WhatsApp Business API)	Order alerts to artisans in Hindi. Onboarding bot. Support messages	Launch critical
Google Vision API	Reverse image search on product uploads to detect stock photos or duplicates	Launch critical
Aadhaar DigiLocker API	Tier 2 seller identity verification: OTP + live selfie match	Phase 2
Google Translate API	Auto-translate seller descriptions and artisan stories to 10 languages	Phase 2
Customs duty API (Zonos or Easyship)	Real-time import duty estimates shown at checkout by destination country and HS code	Phase 2
UPI / Razorpay	Artisan payout in INR via UPI for sellers without international bank accounts	Launch critical

6. Recommended *tech stack*

This stack is standard, well-documented, and easy to find developers for in India and internationally. All choices prioritise speed to launch and cost-effectiveness.

LAYER	TECHNOLOGY	REASON
Frontend	Next.js (React)	Fast, SEO-friendly, used by most Indian dev teams
Backend	Node.js with Express or NestJS	Same language as frontend, fast development
Database	PostgreSQL	Relational, reliable, handles marketplace complexity
File storage	AWS S3 or Cloudflare R2	Product images and seller documents
Hosting	Vercel (frontend) + Railway or Render (backend)	Affordable, auto-scaling, zero-config deployment
Search	Algolia or Typesense	Fast product search with filters and multilingual support
Email	Resend or Postmark	Transactional emails: order confirmations, tracking updates
Analytics	PostHog or Mixpanel	

		Track buyer and seller behaviour, conversion funnels
Error monitoring	Sentry	Catch and fix bugs before users report them

No-code alternative: For fastest launch, use Webflow (marketing site) + Sharetribe Flex (marketplace). This gets you live in 6 to 8 weeks without a developer. Migrate to custom build once revenue justifies it.

7. Pages and features *to build*

Phase 1 — MVP launch (weeks 1 to 8)

- Homepage (design complete in prototype)
- Product listing page with search and category filters
- Product detail page with artisan card (design complete in prototype)
- Cart and checkout — 4 steps (design complete in prototype)
- Seller onboarding — 4 steps with Rs 150 payment (design complete in prototype)
- Seller dashboard — overview, orders, listings, earnings (design complete in prototype)
- Artisan public profile page (design complete in prototype)
- Buyer account: order history and tracking
- Admin panel: approve listings, manage disputes, view platform metrics

Phase 2 — Growth (months 3 to 6)

- WhatsApp onboarding bot (artisan sends photo, AI creates listing)
- Aadhaar DigiLocker seller verification
- Corporate gifting portal (bulk orders, custom packaging)
- Curated gift boxes (seasonal drops, subscription)
- Multi-language support for listings (English, Hindi, German, French, Japanese)
- Artisan video listings (30-second craft process video)
- Review system with photo upload
- Referral program for artisans

8. Brand and *design system*

Do not deviate from the design in the prototype HTML files. All colours, fonts, spacing, and components are defined there. Key values:

ELEMENT	VALUE
Primary colour	#4D5A3A (olive green)
Accent green	#8BC9A0 (mint), #4A9B6F (mint dark), #EAF5EE (mint pale)
Gold accent	#F5C842 (gold), #C4930E (gold deep)
Background	#FFFBF2 (cream), #F7F3EA (warm bg)
Heading font	Cormorant Garamond (serif, weight 300 and 600)
Body font	DM Sans (weight 300, 400, 500)
Logo	S lettermark with sun rays (mint green body, gold rays). Available as PNG. SVG version to be requested from designer.
Logo lockup	S mark + "unartn" text (S is part of the lettermark, not repeated in wordmark)
Border radius	10px for inputs, 14px for cards, 20px for large sections
Button style	Rounded pill (50px radius). Primary: olive fill cream text. Outline: 1px olive border, transparent fill.

Important: The S logo image has a portrait aspect ratio (approximately 0.72 wide to 1 tall). Always set explicit width and height on the img tag to prevent stretching. At 40px height, width should be 29px. Use object-fit: contain. Do not set width: 100% or let containers stretch it.

9. Domain and *hosting setup*

Domain: **sunartn.com** registered with GoDaddy.

DNS records required

TYPE	NAME	VALUE	PURPOSE
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A	@	From Vercel dashboard	Root domain points to frontend
CNAME	www	cname.vercel-dns.com	www subdomain
CNAME	shop	From Sharetribe console	Marketplace (if using Sharetribe)
CNAME	api	From Railway or Render	Backend API
TXT	@	From Stripe	Domain verification for Stripe

SSL certificates are issued automatically by Vercel and most hosting providers. No manual certificate installation required.

10. Budget and *timeline*

No-code route (recommended for launch)

ITEM	COST	NOTES
Webflow CMS plan	\$23 / month	Marketing site, artisan profiles
Sharetribe Flex Essential	\$99 / month	Marketplace engine
WATI WhatsApp Business	\$49 / month	Seller communication
Shiprocket	Pay per shipment	No fixed cost
Stripe fees	2.9% + 30¢	Per transaction
Freelancer to configure Sharetribe	Rs 50,000 to Rs 1,20,000	One-time setup
Launch timeline	6 to 8 weeks	

Custom development route (scale-up)

ITEM	ESTIMATE	NOTES
MVP development (India-based team)	Rs 8L to Rs 15L	3 to 4 months
MVP development (agency or senior freelancers)	Rs 15L to Rs 25L	2 to 3 months
Monthly hosting (Vercel + Railway + S3)	\$50 to \$150	Scales with traffic
Where to find developers		

Toptal, Upwork, LinkedIn,
Bangalore or Delhi agencies

Recommended approach: Launch on Webflow and Sharetribe in 6 to 8 weeks to validate demand and onboard first 100 artisans. Once you have 50 orders per month consistently, commission the custom build. Do not custom-build before you have proven demand.

Sunartn — Developer Brief v1.0 — May 2025 — Confidential
All prototype HTML files provided separately. Design must not be altered without founder approval.